

Other programming roles

There are certain programming roles which usually are not a job title, or even a full-time position on a particular game project, but are still important tasks in their own way. These include Input Programmers who take care of implementing input systems for the game, sound programmers who implement game sounds properly in the game and UI programmers who take care of scripting UI elements of the game.

These need basic programming skills and understanding of game systems and content pipeline. For real-time motion-controlled game utilising devices such as Kinect, we need expert input programmers who can handle complex input methods and maintain low input latency.

Art and Animation

Art and Animation are as vital to games as to animation films and a cartoon TV series. Games need Artists, Animators, Visual Effects Specialists, etc., to give the game the exact look and feel as perceived by the Game Designer and work closely with the development team to keep providing them art assets when needed.

Various expertise/focus roles one can take-up as an artist/animator are:

Technical Artist

The Technical Artist (TA) acts as a link between the Artists and Programmers working on a game project. They ensure art assets can be easily integrated into a game without sacrificing the overall look and feel of the game as presumed by the designer keeping in mind the technical limits of the chosen platform.

What does a Technical Artist do?

- ▶ Work closely with both the art and the programming team to make sure that the art assets reflect and integrate successfully in the game.
- ▶ Decide and maintain the art production workflow.
- ▶ Decide on the choice of art tools to be used.
- ▶ In a more of an advisory position, set up the systems of production as well as solve problems as they arise.
- ▶ Create custom tools to improve the efficiency of their team using the scripting languages included in major modeling packages.
- ▶ Provide feedback or debug complex assets such as skinning systems etc.